



Getting another species to do all the hard work needed to support your lifestyle is a good survival strategy. The secret is not to overdo it.



Plants do it too... Mistletoe is a parasitic plant that lives on other trees. It has special roots that push into cracks in the bark and penetrate the wood so that it can draw water and nutrients into its own stems.

## offences committed against them:

*IT WAS AS IF I'D BEEN TAKEN OVER. They were controlling my mind. How horrible is THAT?*



*I thought he was my friend, and then he turned on me and MADE ME HIS SLAVE.*



*Scratch, scratch, scratch—the itching drove me crazy. THEY DIDN'T EVEN ASK me if they could hitch a ride.*



### USURPERS AND BODYSNATCHERS

Bringing up young is hard work so some species have found the perfect solution—get someone else to do it. Certain insects and birds lay their eggs in the nests of other species and get their hosts to raise the offspring with their own. Voodoo wasps are more sinister—they inject their eggs into a caterpillar. The larvae release a chemical that controls the caterpillar's brain and makes it take care of them.

### SLAVERS AND TYRANTS

Several species of ant make slaves of other ants by invading their colony and taking it over, or by their stealing eggs to bring up as servants. The enslaved ants are made to tend to the queen and her eggs, search for food, and defend the colony against attack because the invaders can't do it for themselves. Slaves will even carry their masters to a new colony. The captive ants get their own back by killing the larvae of their oppressors.

### HITCHHIKERS

Hitching a ride on another animal means you don't have to expend energy to find a new source of food. Ticks, lice, and fleas hop onto a passing animal and either suck its blood or use it as transportation to a new host. Fish that are poor swimmers, like the remora, have a sucker to attach themselves to larger fish. Comb jellies are often infested with amphipods (tiny crustaceans) that burrow into their host.